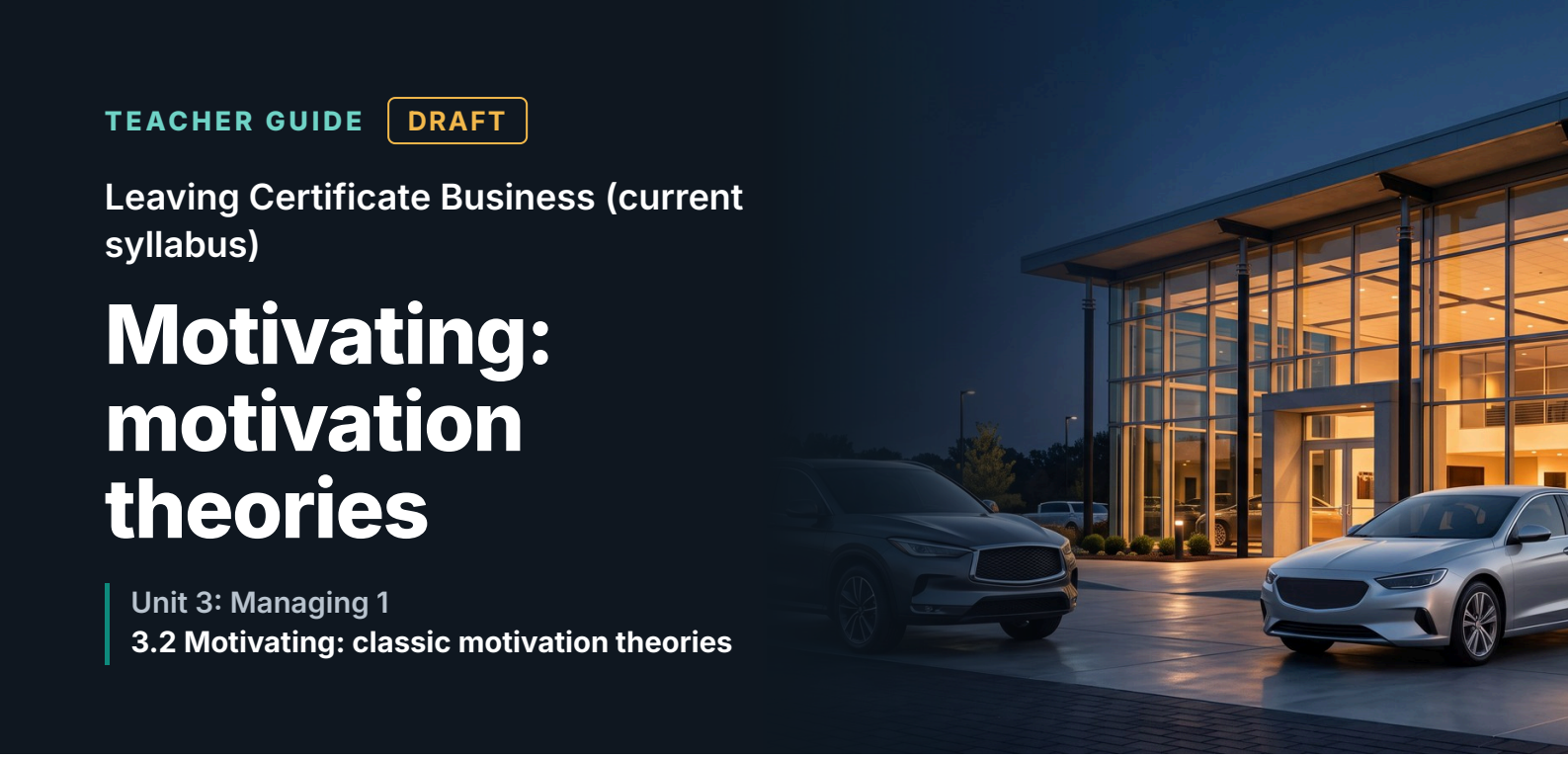
TEACHER GUIDE DRAFT

Leaving Certificate Business (current syllabus)

# Motivating: motivation theories

Unit 3: Managing 1
**3.2 Motivating: classic motivation theories**



A revision lesson. Pupils run a car dealership in firms of four and revise motivating: motivation theories on their own deals. Seat each firm together. Each firm answers the topic tasks together.

## The lesson

45-minute setting

| Setup | Round 1 | Round 2 | Round 3 | Final questions |
|---|---|---|---|---|

### EVERY ROUND

**Firm decisions**
3 min

→

**Deals**
4½–5 min

→

**Topic tasks**
4 min

→

**B2B deal**
2½ min
from Round 2

### LESSON SETTINGS

30 min | **45 min** | 60 min | 75 min

# What pupils do

Every pupil buys and sells cars. In Firm decisions, each role has its own job.



## CEO

**Staff · Sabotage** from Round 2



## Finance

**Capital & Loans · Investments**



## Sales & Marketing

**Marketing**



## Operations

**Seasonal stock**

# Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same. Your Live screen shows each task and every firm's answer.

## 1 Piece rate faults

Round 1

You pay prep staff per car finished, not by the hour. Faults found at handover double.

**What best explains the rise in faults?**

- **A** Staff have too little to do
- **B** Staff now earn less than before
- **C** Staff want more fringe benefits
- **D** Pay now rewards speed over quality

**ANSWER**

**✓ Pay now rewards speed over quality**

**Why:** Paying per car rewards speed, so staff rush and quality falls.

## 2 Staff feel ignored

Round 1

A staff survey says pay is fine, but staff feel ignored.

**Which two changes should motivate most?**

- **A** Ask staff to help set targets
- **B** A 2% pay rise for all
- **C** Closer checks on their work
- **D** Let teams plan their own work
- **E** A bonus for every car sold

**ANSWER**

**✓ Ask staff to help set targets**
**✓ Let teams plan their own work**

**Why:** Feeling ignored is not about pay: involvement and trust tackle it.

## 3 Maslow in order

Round 2

Maslow's hierarchy of needs, at your firm.

**Put the needs in order, lowest first?**

- **A** Safety: a secure contract
- **B** Esteem: praise for good work
- **C** Social: a friendly team
- **D** Physiological: pay for the basics

**ANSWER**

1. **Physiological: pay for the basics**
2. **Safety: a secure contract**
3. **Social: a friendly team**
4. **Esteem: praise for good work**

**Why:** Maslow: physiological, safety, social, then esteem, then self-actualisation.

# Topic tasks

## 4 Piece-rate pay

Round 2

Prep staff are paid per car finished.

**Her pay this week?**

| | |
|---|---|
| Pay per car prepared | **€16** |
| Cars she prepared this week | **46 cars** |
| Extra per car above 30 cars | **€5** |

**ANSWER**

**€816**

46 × €16 + 16 × €5 = €816

**Why:** Piece rate pays for output, so staff work faster, sometimes at the cost of quality.

## 5 Pay or promotion

Round 3

Sales staff are leaving. Exit interviews say pay is fair, but there is no chance to progress.

**What should you offer, and why?**

**A** Training and a clear promotion path

**B** A higher basic salary

**ANSWER**

**✓ Training and a clear promotion path**

**Why:** Pay is not the problem; a chance to grow and progress meets the need staff named.

## 6 Maslow: next need

Round 3

A technician has a secure, well-paid job and friends at work, but feels no one values her skill.

**Using Maslow, which need should you meet next?**

**A** Social needs

**B** Esteem needs

**C** Physiological needs

**D** Safety needs

**ANSWER**

**✓ Esteem needs**

**Why:** Safety and social needs are met; recognition is an esteem need, which comes next.

# Final questions

Each pupil answers 6 final questions. Pick the question topic “Motivating: motivation theories”: the 6 come from these 10 questions.

Then each pupil writes one short answer: “Evaluate piece rate pay for your workshop staff.”

1 In Maslow’s hierarchy, which need is met by a secure job with regular pay?
✔ **Safety (security) needs**

2 A technician is well paid and respected but bored. Which Maslow level is unmet?
✔ **Self-actualisation**

3 A manager who follows McGregor’s Theory X believes that workers...
✔ **dislike work and must be closely controlled**

4 Which action fits a Theory Y approach to staff?
✔ **Giving technicians a say in how work is organised**

5 A salesperson earns €2,000 a month plus 1.5% commission on €80,000 of sales. What is the total pay?
✔ **€3,200**

6 A bonus of €150 is paid for each car above 10 sold in a month. A salesperson sells 16. What is the bonus?
✔ **€900**

7 A dealer offers only cash bonuses, but staff still leave. Which idea from Maslow explains this?
✔ **Higher needs like esteem and belonging are unmet**

8 Which is a non-financial motivator?
✔ **Praise from the manager**

9 Why does a dealer care about staff motivation?
✔ **Motivated staff sell more and stay longer**

10 Mechanics are given responsibility for whole jobs instead of single tasks. Which approach is this?
✔ **Job enrichment**